

Break Your Own Site

Hardening Review & Evidence — Ready for Submission

Portfolio: Muhammad Ayyan Hassan — ayyan-hassan-portfolio.vercel.app

Review type: Structured senior-developer hardening review

Checkpoint: Week 7 — Break Your Own Site

1. Senior Developer Review

Reviewer: Senior Web Developer / Application Security Review

Overall decision: PASS. The site was intentionally tested against empty, malformed, boundary, unusual-character, duplicate-submission, browser, mobile, link, API, findability, social-preview, and performance scenarios. The evidence shows that the core portfolio experience is stable and that the identified fix-now issues were addressed before this review.

The review does not treat every unusual input as a vulnerability. Garbage-looking text can still be legitimate user text, and HTTP 405 for a GET request to a POST-only contact endpoint is expected defensive behavior. The review therefore focuses on observable defects and launch relevance.

2. Test Results

#	Test / attack	Result	Disposition
1	Empty form	Required validation blocked submission.	PASS
2	Whitespace-only input	Previously produced vague error; corrected message now appears.	FIXED
3	Garbage input	Message sent successfully.	PASS — acceptable
4	Invalid email	Browser rejected missing @ format.	PASS
5	Rapid double submit	Sending state disabled second click.	PASS
6	Script-like input	Sent as text; no execution observed.	PASS
7	Boundary lengths	Name/message input limits enforced.	PASS
8	Special characters	Sent successfully; no breakage.	PASS
9	Unicode/mixed text	Sent successfully.	PASS
10	Submission + refresh	Success, clear, reusable; refresh normal; no duplicate.	PASS
11	Wrong API method	GET returned HTTP 405.	PASS — expected
12	Edge browser	Layout/functionality worked, including narrow frame.	PASS
13	All links	Internal/external links worked.	PASS
14	Search/findability	Portfolio surfaced for URL/name searches; LinkedIn also surfaced.	PASS / indexing note
15	Social preview	Title and AH preview image appeared.	PASS
16	PageSpeed	Mobile + desktop reports captured.	PASS / evidence
17	Final mobile check	No layout/functionality issue reported.	PASS

3. Fix-Now Findings and Resolution

F-01 — Whitespace-only validation feedback. The original UI allowed whitespace-only values to reach the API and then surfaced the rejection as a generic “Something went wrong.” This was a UX defect because a user-facing validation problem was presented as an unspecified system failure. The form was updated to validate trimmed input and provide explicit guidance. Post-fix regression passed.

F-02 — Social-share preview image. The portfolio had title/description/Open Graph metadata but lacked an explicit preview image. A dedicated social preview asset and metadata were added. Preview testing subsequently showed the AH image and portfolio title.

4. Known Limitations

KL-01 — Rate limiting / anti-spam. The public contact endpoint has input validation and length limits but no dedicated rate-limiting/anti-spam layer. This is recorded as future hardening work. It is not classified as a launch blocker for this personal portfolio.

KL-02 — Search-result association. Search engines may surface the LinkedIn profile prominently for a personal-name query. This is an indexing/ranking observation, not a portfolio functionality defect.

KL-03 — FlyRank badge pending. The badge is not present because the capstone is currently under review. This is an external status dependency, not a site defect.

5. Senior Review — Required Questions

Did the owner genuinely try to break the site? Yes. The test set included empty input, whitespace, invalid email, boundary lengths, script-like text, unusual characters, duplicate-submit behavior, refresh behavior, unsupported API method, browser compatibility, mobile layout, links, findability, social preview and performance.

Were fix-now findings actually fixed? Yes. The whitespace validation issue was corrected and explicitly re-tested. Social-share metadata was hardened with a preview image and subsequently verified.

Are remaining issues hidden? No. Rate limiting/anti-spam and search indexing behavior are explicitly documented as known limitations/observations.

Are there launch-blocking defects? None identified from the reviewed evidence.

Final recommendation? PASS. Proceed through the hardening checkpoint and launch process, while retaining the known limitations for future iteration.

6. Reviewer Context Notes

This review was performed as a structured senior-developer assessment using the live-site test evidence and implementation behavior available for the portfolio. The purpose was to challenge the site rather than validate only the happy path. The review intentionally distinguishes defects from expected behavior and does not inflate minor observations into security findings.

The strongest finding was the whitespace-only contact-form case: the underlying validation worked, but the feedback was misleading. That was fixed before final assessment. The contact form also demonstrated a protected sending state that prevented the rapid double-submit case from generating an obvious duplicate through the UI.

The review should be read alongside the supplied screenshots/PageSpeed evidence. The performance reports cover both mobile and desktop. The portfolio was also checked in Chrome, mobile, incognito, Edge, and a narrow/mobile frame.

7. Final Hardening Status

CHECKPOINT STATUS: PASS

Fix-now findings: 2 identified / 2 addressed.

Known limitations: 3 documented.

Must-fix items remaining: 0 based on reviewed evidence.